

KW Co-Ed Volleyball League

Playing Rules

Playing Rules are governed by FIVB. Exceptions to FIVB rules and clarifications follow:

The first game of the evening shall start at the time indicated on the schedule. Everyone must be out of the school by 10pm, unless indicated differently by the specific permit for that school.

Game format:

1. Three teams are in each 1/2 gym. The 3 teams will all play against each other throughout the evening according to the schedule.
2. The team not playing will officiate. That team must provide a minimum of three (3) people as such:
 - a. One (1) person to act as referee and two (2) people to call the lines.
 - b. Others may act as scorekeepers, or the lines people can score.
 - c. Referees should bring their own whistle and be familiar with all the rules.
 - d. Lines people should line up diagonally opposite each other at the ends of the court, avoiding the corner where most players begin their serve.
 - e. Those officiating should avoid distractions such as cell phones or other devices.
3. One (1) time out per team per set will be allowed per game.

Line-ups:

1. There must be a minimum of 5 players per court and maximum 3 males (maximum of 6 players total)
2. Playoff eligibility: players must play in 6 regular season games in order to be eligible for playoffs. This applies to both regular players and substitute players.
3. Substitutions: (7 or more players) - Teams with more than 6 players have the following three options:
 - a. Player sits the entire game
 - b. Player sits for one full rotation then subs for one other player (see Rotation), again full rotation. (works out to about half of a game)
 - c. Players enters the rotation from either the 1 or 6 positions only (see Rotation)
 - d. Libero is allowed
4. Rotation:

- a. Except for the beginning service of the game, each time a new team serves, the teams must rotate one spot
 - b. A team has two (2) options of which position players may enter the court:
 - i. Enter at middle back (#6) and then exit after serving (#1)
 - ii. Enter at serve (#1) and exit from the front right (#2) position
- 5. Exception: Rotation with 5 players – C, D1, D2 Divisions:
 - a. Teams with 5 players can only play with 2 in the front row
 - b. There will be no rotating hole and no loss of serve
 - c. A setter can come up from the back row to set, but only the front two can block or hit
 - d. All back row players must line up behind at least one physical front row player
- 6. Exception: Rotation with 5 players – E Division only:
 - a. Teams with 5 players may play with 3 in the front row
 - b. There will be no rotating hole and no loss of serve
- 7. Forfeits:
 - a. Teams must have a minimum of 5 players to begin the first game
 - i. Note: you are allowed to request an extra player from the officiating team, but not a specific player on that team. Whoever volunteers is who you get.
 - ii. The officiating team is under no obligation to provide a player as this increases risk for them (e.g. injury or fatigue prior to their games)
 - b. Teams have a 10 minute grace period before a forfeit for the first game is declared
 - c. A subsequent 10 minute grace period is allowed before the second game is declared forfeit and also for the third. At such time the match would then be forfeit
 - d. Exceptions can be made if the captain of the team with less players requests it of their opponent. If the other captain agrees, the games will count
 - e. If no exception is agreed to ahead of time, the game is considered a forfeit
- 8. Late arrivals:
 - a. Late arriving players may enter play once all players and substitutes have entered play in that game
 - b. If a team is playing with 5, the arriving player may enter play immediately

Clarifications on Play and Court:

- 1. Net height: The net shall be placed at the Junior Men's Level (2.35m)
- 2. Scoring:
 - a. Rally Point. A rally is a sequence of playing actions from the moment of the service hit by the server until the ball is out of play. If the serving team wins a

- rally, it scores a point and continues to serve; if the receiving team wins a rally, it scores a point and it must serve next.
- b. Sets are won by the team which first scores 21 points with a minimum lead of two points.
 - i. No cap (even if you go beyond the room available on the scoresheet)
- c. Matches will be 3 sets (all to 21 points), regardless of who wins the first 2.
- 3. Net and Court Violations:
 - a. Contact with the net by a player between the antennae, during the action of playing the ball, is a fault.
 - b. The action of playing the ball includes (among others) take-off, hit (or attempt) and landing.
 - c. Center-line violations occur if one foot completely crosses the center line which means that the whole body excluding the feet can fall across the center line provided that the feet remain on, above or behind the center line and provided that the player does not interfere with any opposing player
- 4. Back court attack hits are permitted. The player must be behind the attack line before leaving the floor to make the hit, and can land anywhere on their own side of the net. If there are not volleyball specific lines on the gym floor, please identify via other lines where the attack line will be judged.
- 5. Double hits:
 - a. Allowed when blocking or receiving an attack hit by the team, as long as it is during one action by the player.
 - b. As of June 2026, OVA is no longer calling doubles on second contact volleys, so long as the ball remains on that team's side. This league will follow suit.
- 6. These are all faults:
 - a. Assisted hit: whenever a player takes support from a teammate or structure/object (e.g. wall) in order to hit the ball.
 - b. Catch: the ball is caught and/or thrown; it does not rebound from the previous hit (look for a pause during the hit from when the ball touches the player till when it leaves the player if there is one, it's likely to be a catch and/or throw). This applies to sets and what we've always referred to as lifts.
 - c. 4 hits
- 7. Attacking and Blocking: a player may place their hands and arms beyond the net, provided that this action does not interfere with the opponent's play. Thus, it is not permitted to touch the ball beyond the net until an opponent has executed an attack hit. An attack hit is defined as all actions which direct the ball toward the opponent (except serves and blocks), and during an attack hit, tipping is allowed only if the ball is cleanly hit, and not caught or thrown.
- 8. Ceiling / overhead obstructions:
 - a. A ball hitting the ceiling or an overhead obstruction (lights, fan, or basketball hoop lying horizontally) above a playable area shall remain in play provided the ball contacts the ceiling or obstruction on the side of the net that is occupied by the team that last played the ball.
 - b. You can not bounce the ball off the ceiling to your opponents

9. The ball is "out" when:

- a. the part of the ball which contacts the floor is completely outside the boundary lines
- b. the ball touches an object outside the court
- c. the ball crosses completely under the net
- d. the ball touches the antennae, ropes, posts, or the net itself outside the side bands. If there are NO antennae or side bands, the lines people will assist in making these "out" calls